WEEK 11 · LECTURE L1 · UNIT IV

Recognition Program Design

Forms of recognition, the reinforcement evidence, how recognition is received, and designing for Indian workplaces.

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi

DSEH004 · Performance Management and Employee Engagement · M.Com. PGCF 2025 · Exam preparation edition

AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Distinguish the four forms of employee recognition.
- Evaluate the evidence on recognition and reinforcement.
- Explain when recognition supports or undermines motivation.
- Design recognition that fits a collectivist, family oriented culture.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 5 (create high engagement cultures).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

Recognition is simply a cheaper form of pay.

Agree or disagree.

Four forms of recognition

Form	Recognizes	Example
Personal	The person as an individual	Remembering what matters to them
Work practice	How the work is done	Praising a careful quality check
Job dedication	Effort and commitment	Thanks for staying through peak season
Results	Outcomes achieved	Celebrating a target met

EXAM LENS

Most programs recognize only results. The other three forms reach people whose results depend on others.

THEORY IN DEPTH · STAJKOVIC AND LUTHANS (1997, 2003)

The reinforcement evidence

THE CORE IDEA

Organizational behavior modification improved task performance by about 17 percent on average.

HOW IT WORKS

Money, feedback and social recognition each improved performance; combined, the effect was largest.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Effects were stronger in manufacturing than in service settings, and for simple tasks.

IN PRACTICE

A warehouse combines a small bonus with daily feedback and public thanks for accuracy.

EXAM LENS

Use it to show recognition is a real performance lever, not decoration. Then add the SDT caution.

HOW RECOGNITION IS RECEIVED

Informational or controlling, and compared

SELF DETERMINATION · DECI, KOESTNER AND RYAN (1999)

Verbal recognition that informs competence supports intrinsic motivation; recognition used to control undermines it.

EQUITY · ADAMS (1965)

People compare the ratio of their outcomes to inputs with others'. Public awards invite comparison.

THE INDIAN CONTEXT

Designing for collectivism, family and festivals

COLLECTIVISM · HOFSTEDE (2001)

Team recognition may carry more weight than singling out one person.

FAMILY

Recognition that includes the family can extend its meaning.

FESTIVALS

Timing around regional festivals can signal respect, if it is not tokenistic.

COURSE FRAMING

The family and festival design ideas are course framing for discussion, not tested findings.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Employee of the month, four theories

Theory	Prediction
Reinforcement	Raises the recognized behavior
Self determination	Supports motivation if informational, harms it if controlling
Equity	Those not chosen compare and may withdraw
Collectivism	Singling out may embarrass and isolate the winner

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Recognition programs work because they reinforce behavior." Critically evaluate using three theories. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Stajkovic and Luthans; adds SDT and equity theory; distinguishes the four forms; proposes a design.

Design a recognition program for an Indian manufacturing firm. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses the four forms; balances team and individual; makes recognition informational; addresses equity and culture.

Name the four forms of recognition. **10 marks**

A strong answer: lists and explains each with an example; cites Brun and Dugas.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Recognize practice, dedication and the person, not only results
2. Recognition that informs helps; recognition that controls harms
3. Public awards invite comparison: design for equity

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Brun, J. P., & Dugas, N. (2008). An analysis of employee recognition: Perspectives on human resources practices. *International Journal of Human Resource Management, 19*(4), 716–730.

Edmondson, A. C. (1999). Psychological safety and learning behavior in work teams. *Administrative Science Quarterly, 44*(2), 350–383.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 11 set readings. Brun and Dugas (2008) is the core reading for this lecture. The Lesson Plan also lists in house sample memos, which are not needed for the examination.

THEORY SOURCES · FOR REFERENCE

Sources for this lecture (1 of 2)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Adams, J. S. (1965). Inequity in social exchange. In L. Berkowitz (Ed.), *Advances in experimental social psychology* (Vol. 2, pp. 267–299). Academic Press. https://doi.org/10.1016/S0065-2601(08)60108-2

Brun, J. P., & Dugas, N. (2008). An analysis of employee recognition: Perspectives on human resources practices. *International Journal of Human Resource Management, 19*(4), 716–730. https://doi.org/10.1080/09585190801953723

Deci, E. L., Koestner, R., & Ryan, R. M. (1999). A meta analytic review of experiments examining the effects of extrinsic rewards on intrinsic motivation. *Psychological Bulletin, 125*(6), 627–668. https://doi.org/10.1037/0033-2909.125.6.627

Sources for this lecture (2 of 2)

Hofstede, G. (2001). *Culture's consequences: Comparing values, behaviors, institutions, and organizations across nations* (2nd ed.). Sage.

Stajkovic, A. D., & Luthans, F. (1997). A meta analysis of the effects of organizational behavior modification on task performance, 1975–95. *Academy of Management Journal, 40*(5), 1122–1149. https://doi.org/10.2307/256929

Stajkovic, A. D., & Luthans, F. (2003). Behavioral management and task performance in organizations: Conceptual background, meta analysis, and test of alternative models. *Personnel Psychology, 56*(1), 155–194. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.2003.tb00147.x